

If you answer YES, or don't know, to any of these questions...

1. Are you taking simvastatin (Lipex® or Arrow-Simva®) and experiencing any side effects such as muscle aches or an upset stomach?

☐ Yes ☒ No

2. Is your LDL cholesterol higher than 2.5mmol?

☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ Don't know

...then ask your doctor about treatment options
and if you would benefit

from LIPITOR (atorvastatin)

You may or may not qualify for funded LIPITOR, so ask your doctor for details.

**LIPITOR has been shown to reduce the risk
of heart attacks in patients.³⁻⁴**

LIPITOR has a well established safety profile.² It has been studied in more than 400 ongoing and completed clinical trials and has been available for over 10 years.[#] However, like all medicines, LIPITOR can be associated with side effects. Please speak to your doctor and read the LIPITOR consumer medicine information leaflet for more information.

LIPITOR is only funded in New Zealand under Special Authority Criteria.⁵ This means that your doctor can only prescribe you funded LIPITOR if you have a calculated absolute risk of cardiovascular disease of at least 15% over 5 years and

- have experienced side effects such as constipation, flatulence, abdominal pain, headache, muscle weakness and others to simvastatin, the other widely available statin in New Zealand⁵
- have not reached your target cholesterol level (LDL-cholesterol or Total-cholesterol) despite being on a dose of 80mg a day of simvastatin.⁵

Lipitor Consumer Mandatories:

Lipitor (atorvastatin 10mg, 20mg, 40mg tablets) is a Prescription Medicine for the treatment of raised blood lipid levels (cholesterol) and for the reduction in the risk of events like stroke or a heart attack in patients with existing CHD. Ask your doctor if LIPITOR is right for you. Use strictly as directed. You should not take LIPITOR if you have had an allergic type reaction to atorvastatin. Tell your doctor if you are pregnant or breast feeding, have acute liver disease, have had muscular pain, tenderness or weakness from other medicines used to treat cholesterol or triglycerides. Possible side effects include constipation, diarrhoea, indigestion, stomach pain, nausea, headache and unexpected muscle pain. If symptoms continue or you experience side effects see your doctor. Lipitor is a funded prescription medicine available under

special authority for patients intolerant to simvastatin or inadequately controlled on simvastatin 80mg/day. Further information on LIPITOR is available from www.medsafe.govt.nz or from Pfizer New Zealand Limited, PO Box 3998, Auckland or by calling 0800 736 363. Lipitor is a registered trademark of Pfizer New Zealand Limited.

Reference: 1. Law MR *et al.* *BMJ* 2003; 326: 1423-1430. 2. Lipitor Data sheet. 3. Sever PS *et al.* *Lancet* 2003; 361: 1149-1158. 4. Colhoun MH *et al.* *Lancet* 2004; 364: 885-896. 5. Pharmaceutical Schedule Dec 2008. PHARMAC. # Pfizer Data on File.